The Follow-Up That Isn't Pushy

A cadence that keeps you welcome in their messages — and books the ones who were always going to book.

A Miko Pierson playbook · Bigger Than Shears™

Most stylists follow up once and call it follow-up — if they follow up at all.

Not because they're lazy. Because they don't want to be the message someone screenshots as annoying. The fear is real — but it's aimed at the wrong thing. What makes follow-up feel pushy is *stacking* — five messages in three days that all say "just checking in." Spaced out, permissioned follow-up is read as professionalism. The data backs the cadence — and names the line where persistence stops paying.

The three facts that shape the cadence

- **They prefer the text.** Large consumer surveys keep landing the same answer: roughly half to three-quarters of clients prefer appointment reminders by text, and texting pulls response rates far above calls and email. Your follow-up belongs where the conversation already lives.
- **Spacing beats stacking.** Sales-cadence data shows follow-ups sent roughly three days apart pull about a third more replies than next-day bumps. Persistence isn't frequency — it's presence at the right intervals.
- **There's a natural stopping point.** Large-dataset sales research puts the real conversion curve at about six contacts — beyond that, effort climbs and odds don't. A cadence with an end is a system. A cadence without one is a spiral.

The 6-touch cadence

Each touch carries something for *them* — never just "checking in." Checking in takes; bringing something gives.

1. **Day 0 — the close of the visit.** *"Same chair, four weeks — I'll hold it."* (If they left unbooked: *"Sending your upkeep notes now — easier to book early than to need it late."*)
2. **Day 3 — value, not a nudge.** Care tip or photo of their finish: *"The silver held beautifully — keep it cool-toned with a violet wash once a week."*

3. **Day 7–10 — the helpful window.** *"Your maintenance window lands around the 14th — want me to set it?"*
4. **Day 14–17 — one honest line.** *"Last window I'm holding open for this cycle — want it or want to skip this round?"* (An exit is an acceptable answer; a graceful close earns the next yes.)
5. **Day 30 — a reason to return.** Seasonal note, new service, or a client-exclusive: give the touch a payload, not just a ping.
6. **Seasonal — the long tail.** Three touches a year at the moments that matter (holiday rush, summer, back-to-school). Low pressure, permanent presence.

The rules that keep it welcome

1. **Ask permission once.** *"Text okay for reminders?"* — one question at booking, then a channel they chose. Research on consumer messaging preference is blunt: people want to text AND talk, on their terms — a call they didn't expect reads as an intrusion; a text they opted into reads as service.
2. **Every touch gives something.** A tip, a reminder window, a held slot, an exclusive. If the message only asks, it's a debt collector.
3. **Stop means stop.** Two unanswered touches in a row → they move to the seasonal track. Restraint is part of the brand.

A stat to skip

You'll see "80% of sales need five follow-ups" quoted everywhere — including in this industry's seminars. Nobody can produce the study. Quote the real numbers instead: most businesses stop after one contact, and the conversions live in touches two through six. You don't need a fake statistic to justify a real cadence.

Follow-up isn't chasing — it's holding the door open at the right intervals. Who on your list deserves the door held for them this week?

Sources: Phreesia consumer survey (n≈14,000 — 48% prefer text reminders); Podium Local Business Messaging Trends (text response-rate advantage); EZ Texting 2022 (75% prefer text reminders); Instantly.ai cadence dataset (3-day gaps +31% replies; reply capture by day 10); Velocify contact-strategy data (conversion curve to ~6 touches); Cloudli survey (93% want text+voice options); IvrisTech follow-up-statistics audit (the "80%/5-follow-ups" claim is untraceable — excluded). Survey figures are vendor-published — consistent across providers.